

SUDAN Food Security Outlook

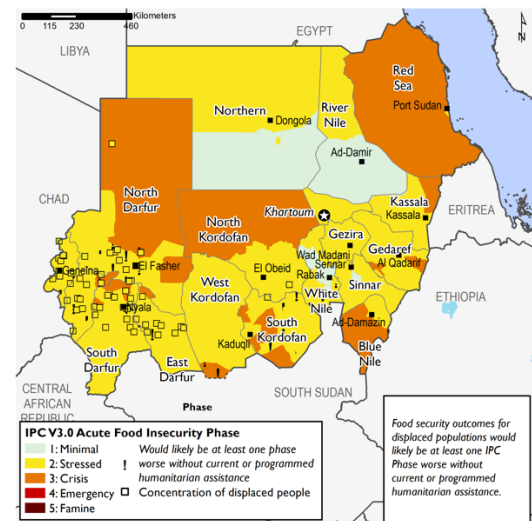
June 2020 to January 2021

Large populations require assistance amid very high staple food prices and COVID-19 restrictions

KEY MESSAGES

- Large numbers of people will require emergency food assistance in Sudan through September 2020, as very high staple food prices and COVID-19 control measures significantly limit food access during the lean season. Worst-affected areas will be in Emergency (IPC Phase 4), including parts of Jebel Marra and South Kordofan, Red Sea and Kassala states. Large populations are expected to be in Crisis (IPC Phase 3) in western Sudan and urban centers, such as Khartoum.
- Staple food prices remain extremely high, outpacing increases in livestock prices and wage labor rates. In many markets, household purchasing power is well below levels observed in recent years. Beyond the lean season, staple food prices are expected to remain extremely high and, amid the expected continuation of COVID-19 control measures, large numbers of people are expected to require humanitarian assistance.
- Harvests starting in October will begin to improve food access among agricultural and agropastoral households, and food security should improve from Crisis (IPC Phase 3) to Stressed (IPC Phase 2) for many poor households. Still, large areas of Red Sea state, northern areas of North Kordofan and North Darfur, and conflict-affected areas of Jebel Marra and South Kordofan will remain in Crisis (IPC Phase 3). Moreover, urban households who typically depend on unskilled labor in urban areas and who lack access to sources of food that improve seasonally (such as harvests or milk from livestock) will continue to face difficulty meeting their basic food needs.

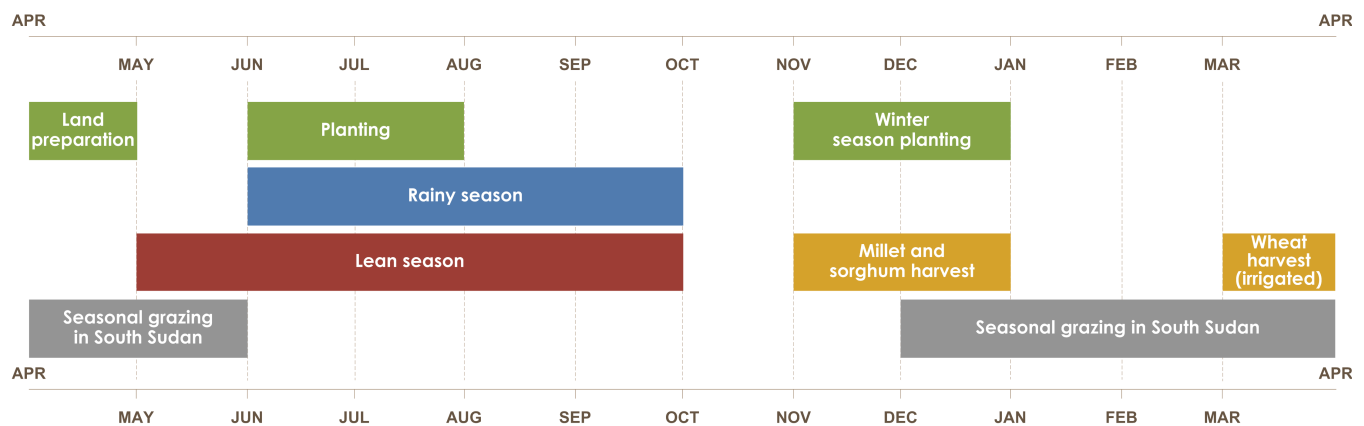
Current food security outcomes, June 2020



Source: FEWS NET

FEWS NET classification is IPC-compatible. IPC-compatible analysis follows key IPC protocols but does not necessarily reflect the consensus of national food security partners.

SEASONAL CALENDAR FOR A TYPICAL YEAR



NATIONAL OVERVIEW

Current Situation

COVID-19 outbreak and control measures

Sudan continues to face a growing COVID-19 outbreak. As of early July, over 10,000 confirmed cases of COVID-19 have been reported in Sudan, including 636 deaths, according to the Federal Ministry of Health (FMOH). Confirmed cases have been reported in all 18 states of Sudan, with about 75 percent of the cases registered in Khartoum. Increasing numbers of suspected COVID-19 cases are reported to be in quarantine in Sudan's isolation centers.

Measures intended to control COVID-19 remain in place in Sudan as of late June 2020. These include the closure of airports, seaports, and land crossings. Specific measures vary from state to state, with most implementing curfews, lockdowns, and work-from-home policies.

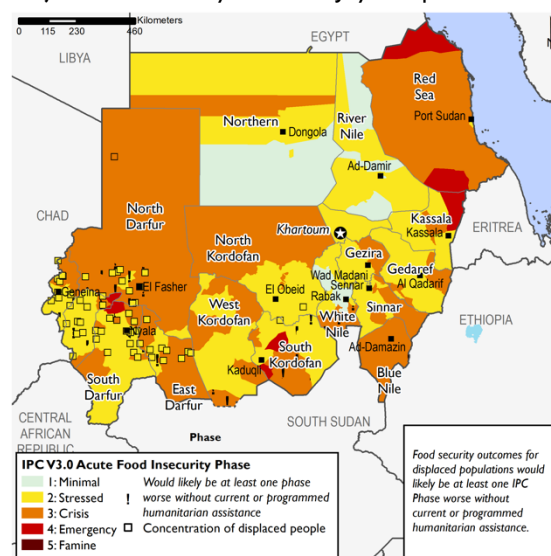
Compliance with COVID-19 control measures and health recommendations is reported to be weak in Sudan. Although some mask-wearing is observed, it is not universal and respect for social distancing is very low in urban and rural areas. Meanwhile, government enforcement of control measures and response to non-compliance is not as strong as at the beginning of the outbreak. Moreover, in early July, the government decided to ease COVID-19 measures that were imposed in late March 2020. Mosques have been reopened and the curfew in Khartoum state will be limited to the hours between 18:00 and 05:00.

Macroeconomic crisis

Sudan continues to face a macroeconomic crisis, exacerbated by reduced economic activity due to COVID-19. Sudan continues to face severely limited reserves of foreign currency in the official banking system. In recent years, Sudan's ability to access sufficient foreign exchange has been limited due to structural economic factors. In addition, the Federal Ministry of Finance and Economic Planning reports that Sudan has lost more than 200 billion SDG in revenue due to restrictions on economic activity related to COVID-19. This, coupled with an increasing reliance on imports for essential food and non-food items (agricultural inputs, health and medical equipment, etc.), are placing additional pressure on Sudan's already limited capacity to meet foreign exchange needs.

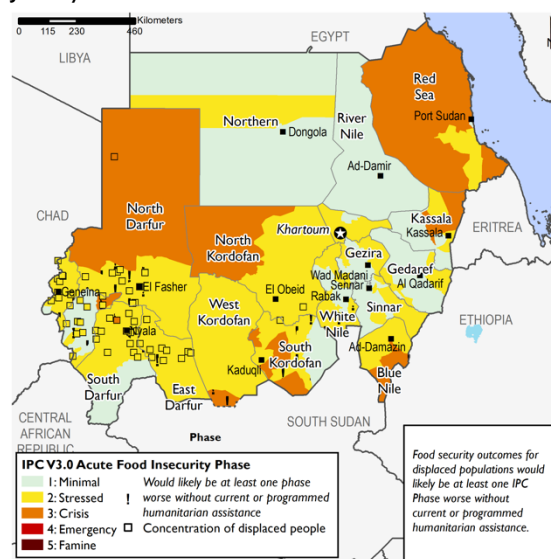
The Sudanese Pound has continued to depreciate on the parallel market and the inflation rate continues to rise. As of June 2020, the parallel market exchange rate reached 145 SDG/USD compared to 130 SDG/USD in March, while the official exchange rate remained 55 SDG/USD during March and April compared to 52 SDG/USD during February 2020. Meanwhile, the annual inflation rate increased from approximately 99 percent in April 2020 to more than 114 percent in May 2020. This has occurred alongside measures taken by the Ministry of Finance to increase civil servants' salaries on average by about six-fold (from a minimum of 425 SDG to 3,000 SDG) between April and May to help them cope with rising prices. Despite recent pledges by the humanitarian community to provide 1.8 billion USD to Sudan in support of economic reforms, assistance to the Sudanese economy has not yet materialized as of June 2020.

Projected food security outcomes, July to September 2020



Source: FEWS NET

Projected food security outcomes, October 2020 to January 2021



Source: FEWS NET

FEWS NET classification is IPC-compatible. IPC-compatible analysis follows key IPC protocols but does not necessarily reflect the consensus of national food security partners.

*2020/21 seasonal progress***The June to September 2020 rainy season has begun on time in most parts of Sudan.**

As of early July, total seasonal rainfall has reached between 100 and 200 mm in southern areas of Sudan, and between 50 and 100 mm in areas further north. According to CHIRPS, rainfall performance has been mixed to date, and the Normalized Difference Vegetation Index (NDVI) suggests normal to above normal vegetation conditions in eastern Sudan, with areas of below-average vegetation in South Kordofan, South Darfur, Central Darfur, and West Darfur. However, the heaviest rainfall typically occurs between July and September, during which time crop water needs are greatest.

Land preparation has continued in recent weeks in agricultural and agropastoral areas of Sudan, while planting of cereals is underway in some areas.

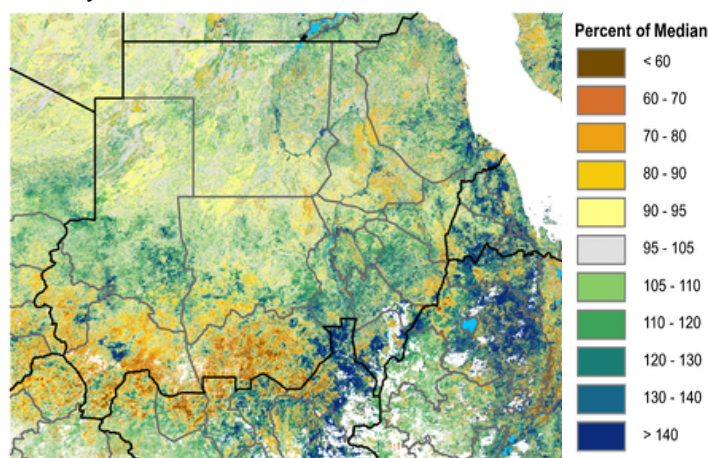
Land preparation has continued across most parts of Sudan during late June, although field reports indicate that restrictions on population movements in response to COVID-19, continued fuel shortages, and high costs of transportation have constrained land preparation activities. According to state level monitoring information, rainfall is sufficient for planting of cereal crops, which was underway in late June in parts of the semi-mechanized sector in southern Al Gadarif, Blue Nile, and Sennar states, as well as in parts of the traditional sector in South Kordofan, West Kordofan, and South Darfur. Meanwhile, dry sowing of millet has been reported in some areas of the Darfur and Kordofan states. Planting of cereal crops has not yet started in most of the irrigated and traditional sectors.

Meanwhile, planting of cash crops such as groundnuts and cotton is underway in the irrigated sector, having reached an estimated 50-60 percent of the area targeted for planting by the end of June. Planting of sesame and groundnuts continued in the rain-fed sector and as of late June, 10-20 percent of the targeted area has been planted in North Kordofan, West Kordofan, and East Darfur states. Crops are mostly at the early germination stage. Meanwhile, provision of inputs to farmers in parts of the semi-mechanized and irrigated sectors is still ongoing. Approximately 60-80 percent of the fuel allocated by the government to support agricultural activities has been delivered to targeted states, though delays are being reported in the arrival of seeds allocated by the government.

The potential expansion of desert locust infestations remains a concern as scattered bands of locusts are being reported in Sudan. According to the [June 2020 Desert Locust Bulletin](#), scattered mature adults were present in the Nile Valley from Shendi to North Dongola, the Baiyuda desert to northern Khartoum, in the east between Kassala and Sinkat, and in the South between Kosti and South Sudan borders. The presence of desert locusts during this period is a potential threat to crops in these areas.

Rainfall in June has facilitated favorable pasture regeneration across most pastoral and agropastoral grazing areas in Sudan. The Normalized Difference Vegetation Index (NDVI) suggests vegetation conditions are above the median in most areas of North Darfur, Red Sea, and Kassala states, with areas of above and below median vegetation in North Kordofan (Figure 1). The USGS water point viewer indicates good water conditions across most monitoring points. As of late June, nomads have continued seasonal migration with their animals from the summer season grazing areas in southern Sudan, South Sudan, and the Central African Republic (CAR) towards the wet season grazing areas further north in Sudan. Field reports indicate that some pastoralists have already crossed the borders on their way to the north, and some nomads have raised concerns about expansions in agricultural areas and the closure of animal migratory routes. Generally, improved pasture and water availability have improved animal body conditions in the main pastoral and agropastoral areas.

Figure 1. Normalized Difference Vegetation Index (NDVI), percent of median, June 21-30, 2020.



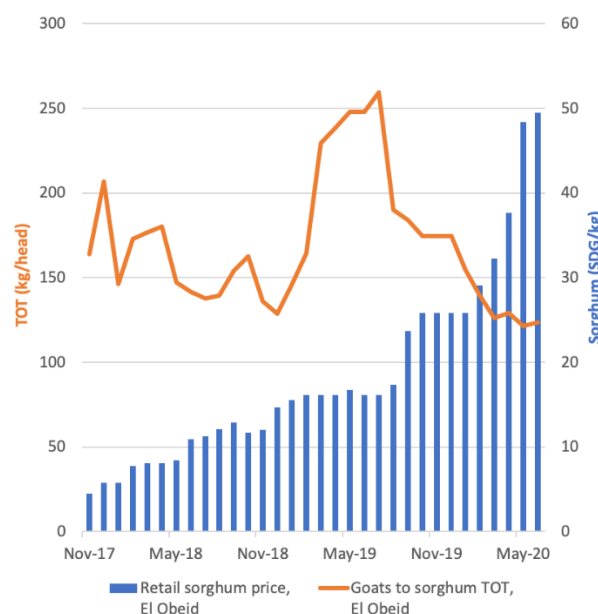
Source: FEWS NET/USGS

Prices and terms-of-trade

Retail prices of sorghum and millet continued to increase between May and June 2020 across most markets in Sudan and remained 150 to 250 percent higher than in June 2019. In Al Qadarif (the most important production market in Sudan), sorghum sold for approximately 67 SDG/kg in June 2020, compared to 14 SDG/kg in June 2019. Across Sudan, sorghum and millet prices are five to six times the recent five-year average for June. Very high sorghum and millet prices are being driven by the continued macroeconomic crisis, associated high production and transportation costs, as well as reduced market supplies resulting from last year's below-average production. Informal cross-border flows of sorghum to Eritria and South Sudan continued between March and June 2020, despite the COVID-19-related border closure. However, March-June 2020 informal cross-border exports of sorghum were estimated at approximately 2,700 MT, compared to 7,000 MT for the same period in 2019.

Although wheat prices have been generally stable or increased slightly over the past 1-2 months, retail wheat prices remain much higher than last year and the five-year average. In Khartoum, the largest wheat consumption market in Sudan, June 2020 retail wheat prices (60 SDG/kg) were more than twice those reported in June 2019 (28 SDG/kg), and nearly four times the recent five-year average (13 SDG/kg). High wheat prices are mainly attributed to high production and transportation costs and shortages of wheat imports.

Figure 2. Goats-to-sorghum terms-of-trade (kg/head), El Obeid market



Source: FEWS NET

Wholesale prices of key cash crops continued to increase between May and June 2020 across most markets in Sudan and remained 150 to 250 percent higher than in June 2019. In Al Qadarif market, one *guntar* (approximately 54 kg) of sesame sold at 3600 SDG in June 2020, which is almost 60 percent higher than in June 2019 and 260 percent above average. In El Obied, the main groundnut production market, the price of groundnut was recorded at 2,920 SDG/*guntar* compared to 1,150 SDG/*guntar* in June 2019. High prices of groundnut and sesame this year is mainly attributed to the high demand for cooking oil for local consumption as well as for export.

Livestock prices have continued to increase in recent months, but have increased less than cereal prices when compared to last year and historical averages. Livestock prices increased by 10-20 percent across most markets between May and June as exports to Saudi Arabia resumed and as already high transportation costs have continued to increase. May 2020 goat and sheep prices are approximately 50-250 percent above May 2019 prices and four to six times the five-year average, while cattle prices are on average 90 percent above June 2019 levels and 325 percent above average.

Opportunities and wages for agricultural labor have also increased, but like livestock prices, increases in staple food prices have outpaced increases in wage labor rates, when compared to last year and historical averages. Agricultural labor opportunities and wages have increased with the progression of the agricultural season, with wages rising between 15 and 30 percent between March and June 2020. Moreover, labor opportunities have improved in the irrigated and rainfed sectors with the beginning of land preparation and planting activities. As of June 2020, labor wage rates are 100-150 percent higher than in June 2019 and 350 percent above the five-year average.

Due to the inability of increases in livestock and labor prices to offset sharp increases in staple food prices since at least mid-2019, household purchasing power is well below normal in many parts of Sudan. In El Obeid market, for example, goats-to-sorghum terms-of-trade in June 2020 (approx. 125 kg/head) are lower than at any period over the past several years (Figure 2). Meanwhile, labor to sorghum TOT remained 30-40 percent lower in June 2019 and 45-60 percent lower than the five-year average in Al Qadarif market.

Humanitarian assistance

In May 2020, WFP provided food assistance to approximately 2.8 million beneficiaries in Sudan, through various modalities including general food distributions (GFD). Among those receiving GFD, it is estimated the average ration was between 50 and 100 percent of the required 2,100 kilocalories. Approximately 50 percent of beneficiaries reached were long-term IDPs in Darfur, South Kordofan, and Blue Nile, 15 percent were South Sudanese refugees and the remaining were returnees, rural residents and urban poor households affected by low production, conflict, and COVID-19 control measures. It is anticipated that this assistance is improving food security among beneficiaries in targeted areas.

Food security indicator data

Between November 2019 and March 2020, the World Food Programme and partners collected food security indicator data in all 18 states of Sudan. The indicators collected include Food Consumption Score, the reduced Coping Strategies Index, and a livelihoods coping module. These data were collected at the locality level, in 180 of the 187 localities in Sudan. No data collection took place in parts of North Darfur (Tina Locality), West Kordofan (Alsunot, Kalilak and Lagawa localities) and South Kordofan (Al Buram, Umdorain and Haiban localities). Moreover, these data were collected prior to the onset of the ongoing COVID-19 outbreak in Sudan and were not intended to represent outcomes in the midst of the outbreak control measures. Finally, in some areas, responses to the survey were provided in the presence of significant humanitarian assistance, meaning that these indicators may have appeared worse had emergency food assistance not been provided.

Overall, the results suggest that, following 2019 harvests and prior to the COVID-19 outbreak, a large number of people in Sudan were likely facing food consumption and irreversible coping that would jeopardize households' ability to meet their food needs in the short and medium term. Given differences in what these food security indicators are designed to capture and the way in which these indicators were collected, a convergence of evidence based on summary results alone is difficult, and would individually produce an extremely wide range of possible estimates of the number of people in need. For example, at the national level, 19 percent of households reported food consumption consistent with Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or worse (i.e. "borderline" or "poor" food consumption). Meanwhile, a very small percentage of households reported consumption-based coping indicative of Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or worse, while more than one third of households reported livelihoods-based coping indicative of Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or worse.

Current food security outcomes

Acute food insecurity continues to worsen in Sudan as households begin to enter the lean season, face poor purchasing power as a result of the ongoing macroeconomic crisis and COVID-19 control measures. Poor households who typically have remaining food stocks at this time of year have likely begun to exhaust them, and those who tend to rely more on markets are facing increasing difficulty accessing sufficient income to purchase food at very high prices. Based on the qualitative and quantitative evidence available, large numbers of people are expected to be in Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or worse acute food insecurity, in the absence of the assistance ongoing in Sudan. Among populations most in need are long-term IDPs located mostly in the Darfur states, conflict-affected populations in South Kordofan and Jebel Marra, chronically food insecure households who typically face food consumption deficits during the lean season, and urban and labor-dependent households worst affected by COVID-19-related restrictions on population movements, economic activity, and trade.

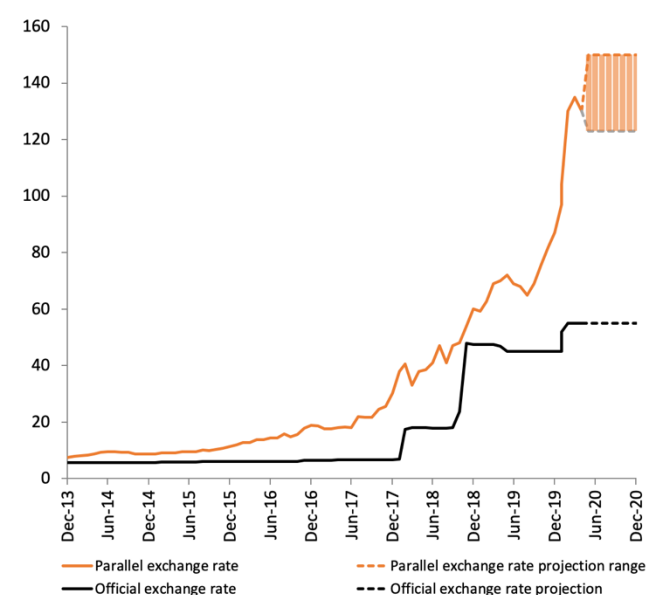
Of greatest concern are areas in South Kordofan and Jebel Marra, where continued displacement, limited market and labor access to due insecurity, high staple food prices, and a lack of humanitarian access to populations most in need are likely resulting in Emergency (IPC Phase 4). Likewise, chronically food insecure areas of Red Sea state, where very poor households are particularly dependent on migratory labor and are similarly affected by very high staple food prices, are also expected to face large food consumption gaps and be in Emergency (IPC Phase 4). In addition to these populations, large numbers of people are facing Stressed (IPC Phase 2) outcomes, meaning households are able to minimally meet their basic food needs but are unlikely to fulfill all of their livelihoods protection needs. Moreover, these households are at further risk of facing food consumption gaps and requiring humanitarian assistance, should food security conditions worsen.

Assumptions

The most-likely scenario for June 2020 to January 2021 is based on the following national-level assumptions:

- The COVID-19 pandemic is likely to continue in Sudan throughout the projection period and we anticipate an increasing number of cases and geographical spread of the pandemic across the country.
- It is assumed that current COVID-19 prevention and control measures will be eased but remain in place during the scenario period. This includes restricting the throughput of people and goods through airports, seaports, and land crossings, and as well as bans on public and private transportation of people between states within Sudan. These measures are anticipated to disrupt typical income-earning opportunities for some populations, and it is anticipated that the effects on food and income sources will persist throughout the outlook period.
- Likewise, exemptions to these restrictions, including for imports of humanitarian assistance, essential health supplies and medicine, imports of wheat and wheat flour, exports of meat and live animals and some agricultural products, and transportation of essential goods between the states are likely to continue.

Figure 3. Integrated FEWS NET exchange rate projection (SDG/USD) on the parallel and official markets



- Compliance with control measures is expected to remain low, but will be more strictly enforced in urban centers compared to rural areas, as farmers and pastoralists continue to migrate livestock and conduct cross-border activities, though at slightly below-normal levels.
- Sudan is likely to continue facing severe macroeconomic difficulties associated with low foreign exchange reserves in the official banking system and the informal market through January 2021. Shortages of foreign currency are likely to continue, and will be exacerbated by increased demand for imports of medicines, sanitizers, personal protective equipment and other essential food and non-food items as part of measures set to control COVID-19. However, some additional income from export of oil crops, animals, and animal products is expected during the post-harvest period.
- Based on FEWS NET's integrated projections, the Sudanese Pound (SDG) is likely to depreciate further on the parallel market and will likely be between 120 and 150 SDG/USD during the scenario period (Figure 3).
- Based on FEWS NET's integrated price projections, retail prices for sorghum and millet are expected to continue increasing into the peak of the lean season in August and September 2020. Overall, sorghum and millet prices are expected to be over 200 percent higher than last year and 400-500 percent above the five-year average during the scenario period. Prices for locally produced wheat will also continue to increase and will remain about 150 percent higher than last year's prices and more than 350-400 percent above the five-year average.
- Sudan is expected to import 1.6 million MT of wheat, compared to 2.5 million for last year and 1.8 million for the five-year average. In addition, Sudan is expected to import 60,000 MT of rice and 23,000 MT of maize overall. Levels of imports will remain below average as a result of the growing shortage of foreign exchange and COVID-19 measures.
- Shortages and high prices of fuel (diesel) are expected to persist across Sudan through January 2021. Fuel prices in remote areas of Darfur, South Kordofan, and Northern states will remain around 50 percent above those in central Sudan, while fuel prices on the informal market will likely be more than twice as high as official prices across the country.

- Internal and cross-border trade flows are expected to be negatively impacted by restricted transportation and population movements resulting from COVID-19 control measures. Flows of locally produced and imported commodities between main production, collection, and consumption markets are likely to be reduced while these measures are in place. Formal trade flows are likely to remain restricted while informal flows are likely to continue at higher than normal costs.
- Poor households' access to food and cash income is expected to be negatively impacted by restricted population movements. Of high concern are poor groups in urban centers dependent on daily wage labor and petty trade, as well as poor households from pastoral and agropastoral communities whose access to cash and in-kind payments would be significantly reduced.
- Remittances by migrant family members in areas of seasonal migration and traditional gold mining in Sudan, as well as remittances by family members abroad, represent a major income source for poor and middle groups in most livelihood zones of Sudan. Remittance levels are likely to be limited and remain below average due to COVID-19-related reductions in population movements, closure of borders, repatriation of Sudanese from some countries, and curfews in areas of migration that restrict household members' access to labor opportunities.
- Livestock prices are expected to slightly increase during the first half of the scenario period and remain relatively stable during the second half of the scenario period. Goat prices are expected to remain relatively stable or start to decrease between May and September, when market supply increases as households sell additional livestock to fund food purchases, at a time when exports to Saudi Arabia are expected to be below average given limitations on the Hajj. Overall, goat prices are expected to remain 30-50 percent higher than last year and 150-180 percent above the five-year average.
- Based on projected cereal and goat prices, goat-to-cereal terms of trade are expected to decline 5 to 10 percent between June and September 2020, and remain on average 20-30 percent lower than last year and 15-20 percent below the five-year average throughout the scenario period.
- Cumulative rainfall during the June to September 2020 rainy season in Sudan is likely to be average and well distributed, with an on-time start and end to the season. This is likely to support planting and development of crops, as well as regeneration of pasture and water resources.
- According to the June 2020 Desert Locust Situation Update, locust swarms in northeast Kenya are expected to move across South Sudan to Sudan and Ethiopia where breeding will occur in July. According to the update, a moderate number of swarms from Kenya and Ethiopia are likely to arrive from early July onwards in Kordofan, White Nile, Blue Nile and Sennar states, while some swarms are also expected to reach the Darfur states. It is also expected that swarms will find good breeding conditions once they arrive in Sudan and hatching and band formation are expected from end-July onwards.
- Given above-average cereal prices and low closing stocks this year, farmers are likely to increase their area planted in cereals compared to last year. However, shortages of labor and agricultural inputs, as a result of macroeconomic difficulties and COVID-19 restricts, are likely to constrain further increases in planting. Area cultivated is likely to remain near average in the traditional and the semi-mechanized rain-fed sectors.
- Agricultural labor opportunities and wages, which are currently at the range of 200-250 SDG per day of work on land preparation and sowing, are expected to increase to 300-400 SDG in the semi-mechanized sector, 150-200 per day for the traditional sector during the weeding (August-September) and harvesting (November to January) periods. Labor wages are anticipated to be 20-50 percent above last year's and more than twice the five-year average due to expected labor shortage as a result of current closure of borders and as laborers demand higher wages in response to continued local currency depreciation and rising prices of other goods and services. Nevertheless, labor-to-sorghum terms of trade are expected to be 30-40 percent lower than last year and 50-60 percent lower than the five-year average.
- Low levels of conflict are expected to be maintained across Sudan during the outlook period. However, sporadic tribal clashes are expected in some parts of western and eastern Sudan. Accordingly, low levels of new internal displacement are expected. Overall, the number of internally displaced people (IDPs) in Sudan is expected to remain around 1.9 million, mostly in Darfur, South Kordofan, and Blue Nile states. Meanwhile, the number of refugees from neighboring countries, primarily South Sudan, is expected to remain near 1 million.

- **WFP and implementing partners are likely to provide emergency food assistance to over four million beneficiaries,** including IDPs and conflict-affected people in Darfur, Kordofan and Blue Nile, and refugees from South Sudan. A scale-up in assistance to an additional 2.2 million people is possible under plans to reach households affected by COVID-19 measures. Although no regular humanitarian access to SPLM-N-controlled areas of South Kordofan and parts of Jebel Marra and Blue Nile is assumed for this scenario period, ongoing peace talks and efforts by the government and SPLM-N could lead to increased access and assistance in these areas.

Most Likely Food Security Outcomes

- Between June and September, the typical lean season in Sudan, access to food and income normally declines as households exhaust their food stocks and rely on market purchases to access food while prices are at their seasonal peak. This year, households' food stocks from own production are estimated to be exhausted earlier. Access to agricultural labor opportunities are expected to remain lower than usual. Increases in rates for wage labor and prices for livestock have failed to keep pace with increases in staple food prices, which are extremely high. Particularly among conflict-affected households, IDPs, and households who chronically face food consumption deficits during the lean season, food security outcomes between June and September 2020 are expected to be more severe than usual. Accordingly, increased localities in pastoral and agropastoral zones across greater Darfur, greater Kordofan, states of western Sudan, Kassala, Red Sea and northern Gadarif in eastern Sudan as well as some localities in urban and semi-urban areas in central Sudan are expected to be in Crisis (IPC Phase 3) between June and September 2020. Emergency (IPC Phase 4) is likely among IDPs in SPLM-N controlled areas of South Kordofan, IDPs and conflict-affected households in Jebel Marra in Darfur and poor households in northern Red Sea state and southern Kassala during the August-September peak of the lean season. During this time, large numbers of people are expected to face Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or worse outcomes, in the absence of humanitarian assistance.
- Between October 2020 and January 2021, the pre-harvest and harvest period, overall food security outcomes are expected to start to improve gradually as agricultural and agropastoral households begin to access food from their own production and in-kind payments from agricultural labor. Increased wages from agricultural labor, the sale of goats, increased consumption of milk from livestock and the sale of livestock products, help will support access to food. Nevertheless, very high staple food prices are expected to continue leading households to face difficulty meeting their basic food needs, particularly as COVID-19 measures continue to limit economic activity. As a result, While many areas will improve from Crisis (IPC phase 3) to Stressed (IPC Phase 2), most conflict-affected areas in greater Darfur, and greater Kordofan currently hosting IDPs and refugees, including parts of Jebel Marra and South Kordofan, southern Blue Nile, some pastoral and agropastoral areas of northern Kassala, and northern Red Sea states will be in Crisis (IPC Phase 3).

Events that Might Change the Outlook

Possible events over the next eight months that could change the most-likely scenario.

Area	Event	Impact on food security outcomes
National	Increased support from international community, significant improvements in macroeconomic conditions.	Improved macroeconomic conditions would improve availability and reduce prices of essential food and non-food items, and improve household purchasing power. This is likely to result in reduced numbers of people facing Stressed (IPC Phase 2) and Crisis (IPC Phase 3) acute food insecurity.
National	Significant increase in the spread of COVID-19, increased numbers of cases, implementation of further strict measures	This would further reduce income-earning opportunities, driving significant increases in the number of people facing Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or worse outcomes, including growing numbers of people facing large food consumption gaps consistent with Emergency (IPC Phase 4).

Area	Event	Impact on food security outcomes
National	Worse than anticipated increases in staple food prices and/or decreases in labor opportunities during the outlook period.	Worse than anticipated increases in staple food prices, arising either from further deterioration in the macroeconomy or restrictions on trade and population movements due to COVID-19 would be likely to drive even higher increases in the number of people facing Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or worse, including notable increases in the number of people facing Emergency (IPC Phase 4) or worse.

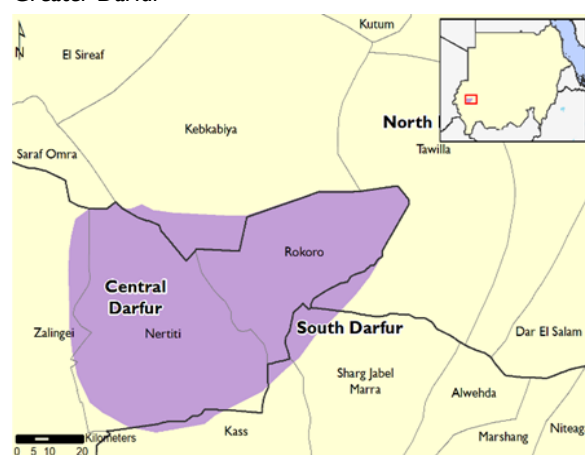
AREAS OF CONCERN

IDPs in inaccessible areas of Jebel Marra SLA-AW (Figure 4)

Current Situation

- Despite relative improvements in security in Jebel Marra since late 2018, household access to cultivation remains low due to continuing insecurity, lack of agricultural inputs, and the shortage and high cost of labor.
- Most IDPs in Jebel Marra depend on the collection and sale of forest products (wood, charcoal and timber), remittances by family members in central Sudan, limited small-scale petty trading in areas of displacement, and unskilled labor in main towns. According to FAO, measures taken to contain and reduce the spread of COVID-19, including lockdowns, restrictions on population movements, temporary closures of markets, and travel bans between and within most states has reduced households' access to key sources of food and income.
- In Zalingei Market of Central Darfur state (the closest accessible market to Jebel Marra) staple food prices continued increasing between March and June 2020. Retail prices of sorghum in June 2020 (53 SDG/kg) are approximately 57 percent higher than in March 2020 (33.9 SDG/kg). June sorghum prices remained more than 260 percent above respective prices last year and more than five times the five-year average, which is broadly consistent with comparisons to recent years in markets across Sudan, and driven principally by the ongoing macroeconomic crisis, and exacerbated by COVID-19 control measures, below-average production, and high transportation costs this year.
- Despite a 16 percent increase in labor wage rates between March and June 2020, labor-to-sorghum terms of trade (TOT) in Zalingei market dropped 26 percent due to the sharp increases in staple food prices. As of late June, TOT remained 30 percent lower than at the same time last year and 45 percent lower than the five-year average. Goats to sorghum terms-of-trade dropped by 20 percent, as livestock prices only increased by six percent between March and June. June 2020 levels of goats-to-sorghum terms of trade remained 37 percent lower than at the same time last year and 18 percent below the five-year average.
- As part of its Comprehensive Food Security and Vulnerability Assessment (CFSVA), WFP collected data on food security conditions and outcomes in accessible areas of Jebel Marra between December 2019 and February 2020, during the harvest period and prior to the ongoing COVID-19 outbreak. No data were reported for Nertiti and Rokoro localities, where IDPs for this Area of Concern are located. Data were reported for nearby Zalingei locality in Central Darfur, Kebkebiya and Tawila localities in North Darfur, and Sharg Jebel Marra and Kass localities in South Darfur. According to this data, even some households in accessible areas near Jebel Marra reported notable percentage of households reported facing having poor or borderline food consumption. Moreover, some households reported engaging in severe coping in order to protect food consumption.

Figure 4. Area of concern reference map, Jebel Marra, Greater Darfur



Source: FEWS NET

Assumptions

In addition to the national-level assumptions above, projected outcomes for IDPs and poor households in SPLA-AW-controlled areas of Jebel Marra are based on the following assumptions:

- Insecurity, including the presence of armed groups and periodic clashes, will continue limiting household access to markets, agricultural land, and key livelihood activities throughout the projection period.
- For those households located in inaccessible areas, access to agricultural labor opportunities in the adjacent government-controlled areas will remain limited during the agricultural season.
- The persistent macroeconomic crisis and ongoing COVID-19 control measures are likely to drive further increases for food and non-food items during the projection period. Crop production costs and transportation costs are likely to increase. Moreover, cereal prices will continue to increase, particularly during the first half of the scenario period. Through January 2021, cereal prices are expected to remain 200-250 percent higher than last year and nearly five times the five-year average.
- Terms-of-trade from labor and livestock to cereals will remain below average (in favor of cereal producers) throughout the scenario period. Goats-to-cereal term of trade are expected to remain 25-50 percent lower than during the same period last year and 20-40 percent lower than the five-year average.

Most Likely Food Security Outcomes

Between June and September 2020, IDPs in inaccessible areas of Jebel Marra are likely to continue depleting any remaining food stocks, while facing extremely high staple food prices and limited income-earning opportunities. Insecurity, the presence of armed groups, and COVID-19 related restrictions along key transportation routes will continue to limit household access to agricultural and non-agricultural labor, as well as collection and sale in relatively secure nearby areas. IDP households will face significant difficulty meeting their basic food needs and will likely face large food consumption gaps, in the absence of humanitarian assistance, between June and September 2020.

Between October 2020 to January 2021, IDP households will begin to access food from their own production as harvesting begins. In addition, IDPs will also begin to gain access to in-kind payments from agricultural labor, further contributing to improvements in food access. However, improvements in food access will be moderated by the limited agricultural activities available due to displacement, insecurity, and COVID-19 control measures. Moreover, staple food prices are expected to remain very high and continue limiting household purchasing power. As a result, IDPs are expected to continue facing significant livelihoods protection deficits and/or small food consumption gaps, resulting in Crisis (IPC Phase 3) between October 2020 and January 2021.

Events that Might Change the Outlook

Possible events over the next eight months that could change the most-likely scenario.

Area	Event	Impact on food security outcomes
Inaccessible areas of Jebel Marra under SLA-AW	Peace talks to reach peace agreement in Jebel Marra further improve security	A peace agreement could improve the security situation, facilitate access to main livelihood sources and markets, increase returns of IDPs and allow access to the area by humanitarian actors. In such a scenario, food security outcomes at the area level could improve to Stressed (IPC Phase 2), and the number of people facing Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or worse would decline significantly.

Poor households in Alguna-Oleep, Gebeit-Maadin, Halayib and Dordeib localities of the Red Sea state (Figure 5)**Current Situation**

- The area of concern for this analysis includes four localities in northern and southwestern Red Sea state: Alguna-Oleep, Gebeit-Maadin, Halayib and Dordeib localities, which are mostly in the Eastern Khors Agropastoral livelihood zone.
- The Crop and Food Supply Assessment Mission (CFSAM) conducted in late 2019 estimated production of sorghum from 2019/20 season at 50 percent lower than of the previous season (2018/19) and 20 percent below the recent 10-year average. As a result, household food stocks were exhausted much earlier than normal this year and households have needed to purchase food from markets for a longer period of time than usual, at prices that are much higher than normal.
- Staple food prices in Red Sea state have continued to increase through the beginning of the lean season in June 2020. Between April and June, sorghum prices in Port Sudan market increased by approximately 10 percent, remaining extremely high compared to prior years. June 2020 prices were more than three times those observed in June 2019, and more than six times the five-year average for June. High cereal prices are being driven mainly by the ongoing macroeconomic crisis, high transportation costs, reduced supplies resulting from low production, and COVID-19 control measures. Prices in markets of areas of focus are reported to be 20-35 percent higher those in Port Sudan market.
- Prices of livestock have also continued to increase, but livestock prices are showing smaller increases than cereals when compared to historical prices. In Port Sudan market, sheep prices increased by 20 percent between April and June 2020, and are approximately 120 percent higher than at the same time in 2019, and five times the recent five-year average.
- Household purchasing power remains weaker than in recent years, as livestock to cereal terms-of-trade have declined following sharp increases in staple food prices. For example, sheep to sorghum terms of trade have increased by 10 percent between April and June but are 20 percent lower than in June 2019 and 18 percent below than the five-year average.
- COVID-19-related control measures, including the closure of borders, lockdowns, and movement restrictions have significantly impacted population movements and market supplies. Household access to casual labor opportunities, particularly in urban areas, remittances, and gold mining activities are reportedly much lower than normal. Moreover, the reduced access to employment opportunities and reduced access to remittances, and closure of borders has resulted in a near complete loss of income from fish exports to Saudi Arabia and seriously affected fish producers.

Figure 5. Area of concern reference map, Red Sea State

Source: FEWS NET

Assumptions

In addition to the national-level assumptions above, projected outcomes for Alguna-Oleep Gebeit-AlMaadin, Halayib, and Dordeib of Red Sea State are based on the following assumptions:

- Cereal prices in Port Sudan market will continue to increase during the June to September lean season and are anticipated to be 150-200 percent above prior year levels, and over 400 percent above the five-year average through January 2021.
- Availability and wages of agricultural labor are expected to improve as planting and weeding activities increase between July to September, and during harvests between November 2020 to January 2021. However, overall access will remain below normal due to COVID-19 restrictions on population movements.
- Availability of pasture and water for animals are expected to improve as the rainy season progresses between June and September, which is expected to improve animal body conditions and milk availability through January 2021.

- Above average rains forecast between June and September 2020 are likely to cause excessive flooding in the *khors* (seasonal rivers), which is likely to damage earlier sown or germinating seeds and result in replanting. Given expected COVID-19 measures, the ability of households to hire labor for replanting may be limited and compromise crop yields.

Most Likely Food Security Outcomes

Poor households in these four localities of Red Sea state are expected to face significantly reduced food access between June and September 2020. During this time of year, poor households typically face seasonal food consumption gaps, which are being worsened this year by low purchasing power resulting from very high staple food prices, and limited ability to access typical levels of labor income. During the lean season, most poor households are expected to increase dependency on wild foods and will reduce the number of meals they consume per day. Moreover, households are expected to adopt irreversible livelihoods coping strategies between June and September in order to offset shortfalls in access to sufficient food and income. Increased numbers of poor households in Aljunaydiya and Gebeit-AlMaadin localities are expected to face Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes, while poor households in the most affected Halayib and Dordieib localities are likely to face Emergency (IPC phase 4) food security outcomes during the peak of the lean season between June and September 2019. Worst-affected households will be poor groups dependent on seasonal labor and non-skilled adult headed households.

Between October 2020 and January 2021, the onset of harvests are expected to improve household access to food from own production and in-kind payments. Nevertheless, this year improvement is expected to be lower than typical during the harvest period, as COVID-19 restrictions limit transportation for labor activities and the continue high prices of staple food prices limit household purchasing power. During this time, households will continue to face large livelihood protection deficits and/or small food consumption deficits and will be in Crisis (IPC Phase 3).

Events that Might Change the Outlook

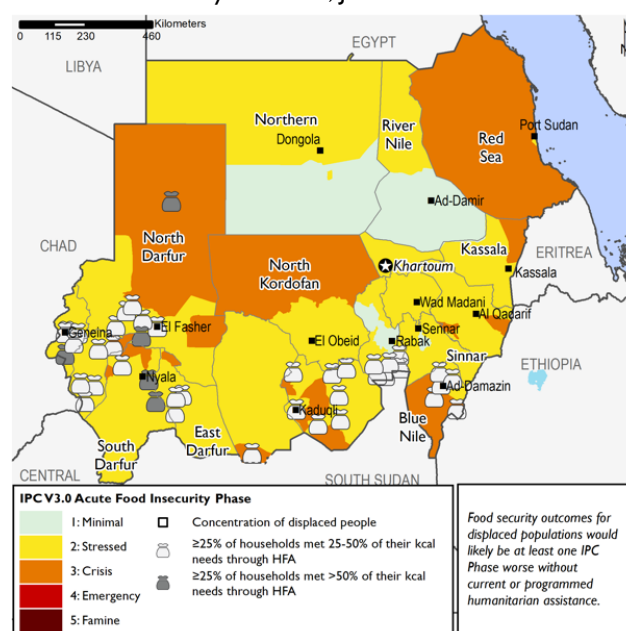
Possible events over the next eight months that could change the most-likely scenario.

Area	Event	Impact on food security outcomes
Dordieib, Gabit-Elmadien and Aljunaydiya-Awlib and Halayib localities of the Red Sea state	Poor performance of the rainy season and significantly below-average harvest from 2020/21 season.	Poor performance and below-average harvest of this season would be the second consecutive year in which poor households face below-average harvests. This would likely result in reduced availability of agricultural labor, limited own production and high food prices. Improvements in food security between October 2020 and January 2021 would be limited, and the number of people facing Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or be much higher than normal during the post-harvest period.

MOST LIKELY FOOD SECURITY OUTCOMES AND AREAS RECEIVING SIGNIFICANT LEVELS OF HUMANITARIAN ASSISTANCE*

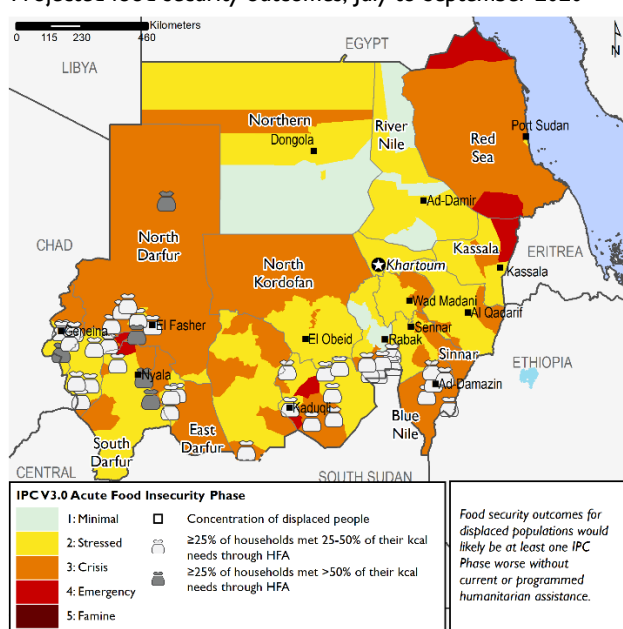
Each of these maps adheres to IPC v3.0 humanitarian assistance mapping protocols and flags where significant levels of humanitarian assistance are being/are expected to be provided. ☹ indicates that at least 25 percent of households receive on average 25–50 percent of caloric needs from humanitarian food assistance (HFA). ☹ indicates that at least 25 percent of households receive on average over 50 percent of caloric needs through HFA. This mapping protocol differs from the (!) protocol used in the maps at the top of the report. The use of (!) indicates areas that would likely be at least one phase worse in the absence of current or programmed humanitarian assistance.

Current food security outcomes, June 2020



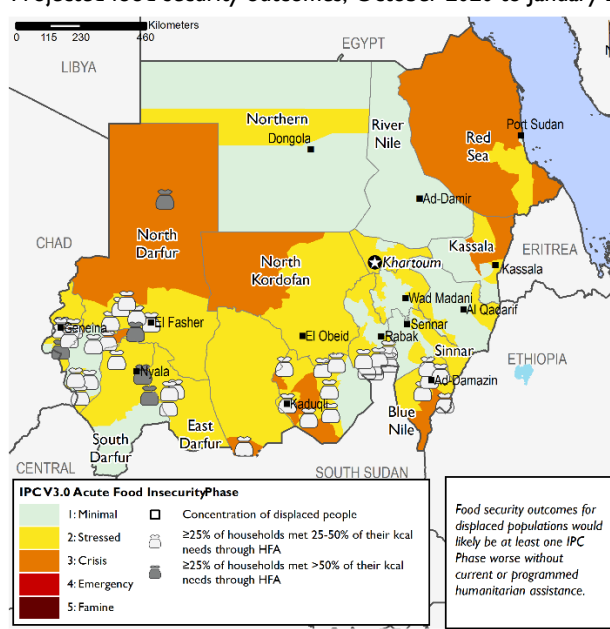
Source: FEWS NET

Projected food security outcomes, July to September 2020



Source: FEWS NET

Projected food security outcomes, October 2020 to January 2021



Source: FEWS NET

FEWS NET classification is IPC-compatible. IPC-compatible analysis follows key IPC protocols but does not necessarily reflect the consensus of national food security partners.

ABOUT SCENARIO DEVELOPMENT

To project food security outcomes, FEWS NET develops a set of assumptions about likely events, their effects, and the probable responses of various actors. FEWS NET analyzes these assumptions in the context of current conditions and local livelihoods to arrive at a most likely scenario for the coming eight months. [Learn more here.](#)